

MALDIVES

Maldives: Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of Maldives
Short Form	Maldives
Capital	Malé
Region (UN)	Asia-Pacific Group
Government Type	Presidential Republic
President	Ibrahim Mohamed Solih (as of 2025)
Currency	Maldivian Rufiyaa (MVR)
UN Member Since	21 September 1965
Permanent UNSC Member	No
MUN Standing	Small island developing state; climate change advocate; tourism-dependent economy

Book Recommendations

Book Title	Author	Why It's Useful
Maldives: Islamic Republic, Tropical Autocracy	Xavier Romero-Frias	Cultural and political background
Climate Change and Small Island States: The Maldives	Saleemul Huq	Key insights on climate impacts and policy
The Maldives: Political Development and Challenges	Mohamed Nasheed (Editor)	Overview of governance and democratic progress
Sustainable Tourism in the Maldives	John Urry	Economic reliance on tourism and sustainability
Human Rights in the Maldives: Report and Analysis	Various NGO Reports	Status of human rights and civil liberties

Research Table: Maldives & the UNHRC

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Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Maldives Profile	OHCHR Maldives	Official country page detailing Maldives' treaty obligations and UNHRC reviews—essential for understanding UN oversight (ohchr.org).
UPR Info – Maldives	UPR-info Maldives	Central hub for Maldives' UPR cycle, including national, UN, NGO input—vital for review process context .
FIDH UPR Report	FIDH Report 2025	NGO report for the 4th UPR cycle, covering key rights violations and recent legal reforms .
Environmental Vulnerability Index (OHCHR)	Earthjustice Report	Highlights environmental rights tied to climate change and its human rights implications .
UN Digital Library – UPR Compilation	UN Compilation on Maldives	UN-consolidated information on Maldives' human rights based on UPR inputs .
HRCM – Maldives UPR 2020	HRCM UPR Submission	National HRCM submission outlining thematic rights challenges and recommendations .
State Department – HR Report	US 2023 Human Rights Report	Comprehensive US govt assessment on prison, judicial independence, freedom of religion, etc. .
Advocates for Human Rights – UPR Stakeholder Report	Stakeholder UPR Report	NGO coalition report exploring death penalty, legal aid, and religious rights .
UNHCR – 2019 UPR Submission	UNHCR Submission	Details on refugee and asylum processes—relevant for UNHRC refugee discussions .
Global Detention Project	Detention in Maldives	Examines refugee and migrant detention practices—key for international detention standards.
Human Rights Watch – LGBTQ arrests	HRW Report 2022 Arrests	Documents politically motivated arrests of LGBTQ individuals—crucial for UN human

Ten Unique Aspects: Maldives in the UNHRC Context

1. **Small-Island State & UPR Influence:** As a small nation, the Maldives' participation in the UPR and its recent submissions from civil society show that even the tiniest countries can make meaningful contributions to the global conversation on human rights.
2. **Death Penalty Debates:** The delicate balance of its moratorium and the ongoing discussions about potentially reinstating capital punishment set the Maldives apart in the UNHRC's conversations on the death penalty.
3. **Religious Homogeneity & Rights Tension:** Living in a strictly Islamic country can really restrict how people express their religious beliefs, which raises some serious concerns on the international stage.
4. **LGBTQ+ Criminalization:** Laws that criminalize homosexuality, along with documented arrests, position the Maldives as a significant case study in the growing challenges to equality recognized by the UNHRC worldwide.
5. **Environmental Rights Visibility:** The Maldives, being one of the countries most at risk from climate change, has a unique connection between environmental degradation and human rights abuses.
6. **Refugee Challenges:** Getting involved in UPR with refugee data, even though we're not a primary host, shows a growing sense of responsibility when it comes to migration rights.
7. **Media & Censorship Issues:** When it comes to freedom of expression, the UNHRC's analyses really highlight issues like media control and restrictions on speech.
8. **Corruption-Reform Nexus:** Recent governance reforms are a key focus in UPR submissions, showcasing a significant shift in the conversation around rights.
9. **Multiagency UPR Engagement:** The participation of UN agencies such as OHCHR, UNESCO, and UNHCR shows a deep commitment to engaging with all stakeholders involved.

10. **UNHRC Membership History:** Even though the Maldives was the smallest member of the UN Human Rights Council from 2014 to 2016, it made the most of its position to shine a light on important issues related to environmental and legal rights.
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